

FOLLOW-UP LESSON

TILKA MAJHI

Session - 1

I Pre-reading



- Socialization
- Do you know whose picture is this? Read the small paragraph in brackets to know about the picture.
[About 200 years ago, when hardly anyone thought of fighting against the British in India, Tilka Majhi, a Santal of Bhagalpur in Bihar fought against them and was hanged by the British. Our History books do not mention his name. We have forgotten this great man who sacrificed his life for the country and showed us the path to freedom. Here you will read about this great man.]

II While-reading

TEXT

- **SGP-1**
- **Read paragraphs 1-3 and answer the questions that follow :**
 1. In 1750, Tilka Majhi was born in Murmu family in a small village near Bhagalpur in Bihar. The village is now called Tilakpur.
 2. The Murmus are priests among the Santals. So Tilka used to worship 'Marang Buru' from his early days. As the days went by, he grew up to be a religious man. People of all religions had great love and respect for him and they called him 'Tilka Baba'.
 3. Tilka was also very good at using bows and arrows. There was none in his area who could surpass him at shooting arrows from a bow. He used to train the young men of the village in shooting arrows.

☛ **Comprehension Questions:**

1. Where was Tilka Majhi born ? When ?
2. What are the Murmus ?
3. Who did Tilka worship ?
4. How did people look up to him ?
5. What did they call him ?
6. What was Tilka good at ?
7. What did he teach to the young men of the village ?

Session - 2

● **SGP-2**

● **Read paragraphs 4-5 silently and answer the questions that follow :**

4. The Santals, as you know , are freedom-loving people. In those days they lived a free life without any outside control. They cleared the forests, prepared fields and grew different kinds of crops. The king had little control over them. Once or twice a year, they had to help the king when there was a war. But after the Plassey battle, the British became the rulers of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha. The king of Bhagalpur came under the control of the British. The British wanted to collect more money. They asked the king of Bhagalpur for more money. The king in turn appointed outsiders to collect rent from the tribals. Some tribal villages were given as 'pattas' by some landlords. The landlords asked the Santals to pay more taxes and often took away their property and lands.
5. Tilka did not like this. He asked the Santals not to pay taxes. The Santals became a real problem for the Government. To bring the Santals under control, a new collector was appointed in Bhagalpur. His name was Cleareland. In different ways, he tried to bring the Santals under control. He appointed soldiers from other tribes to fight against the Santals. Tilka could not bear this. He was looking for a chance to kill Cleareland.

☛ **Comprehension Questions :**

1. The Santals are born free and hardly obey any control. Which sentences have this idea ?
2. What did they do to get their bread ?
3. How did they help the king ?
4. Who became the ruler of their land after the Plassey battle ?
5. What did the British want ?
6. What did the king do to collect rent from the tribals ?
7. What were given as 'Pattas' to landlords?

8. How did the landlords trouble the tribals?
9. What did Tilka ask people not to do?
10. What did the government do to bring the Santals under control ?
11. Who was Cleareland ?
12. What did he do to bring the Santals under control ?
13. Did Tilka like it ? What was his plan?

Will he come out successful in his plan?

Read the next part of the lesson silently to know it.

Session - 3

- **SGP-3**

- **Read paragraphs 6-7 silently and answer the questions that follow :**

6. The chance came. On the morning of 23rd January , 1784 , Cleareland was riding to his house on horseback. Tilka shot an arrow from a distance and killed him on the spot. The news of Cleareland's death spread everywhere. The government brought more soldiers and weapons. But Tilka and his people fought about a year killing many British soldiers with their arrows. At last they made a sudden attack on Tilka and his followers. Tilka was arrested. He was mercilessly beaten. His hands were then tied to a horse and he was dragged all over Bhagalpur town. But Tilka did not die after all this. So they hanged him from a tree. The place is known today as Tilka Chhak.
7. History has forgotten Tilka Majhi ; his name is not found in the history books. But many people who came to Bhagalpur pay their respects to Tilka. In 1969, the Simanta Gandhi , Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, came to Bhagalpur. He went to Tilka Chhak where Tilka was hanged and paid his respect to this great martyr.



A statue of Tilka Majhi at the Tilak Chhak in Bhagalpur

Comprehension Questions

1. How was Cleareland killed ?
2. What did the Government do to control the tribals ?
3. How long did the tribal rebellion continue ?
4. What happened to it at last?
5. How did the great son of soil breathe his last ?
6. Where is Tilka Chhak ? Who was it named after ?
7. Who was Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan ?
8. What is he called?
9. When did he visit Tilka Chhak ? Why ?
10. Can you name some tribal leaders of Odisha who were great freedom fighters ?

Session -4

III

Post-reading

Teacher will design some activities following the activities under Post-reading section of the main lesson. However, some activities have been given.

(a) Match a with their ideas under B. Write paragraph numbers in brackets.

A
(Paragraph No)

B
(Ideas)

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- The birth of Tilka Majhi

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- Tilka Baba

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- good at using bows and arrows

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- trained young men at shooting arrows

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- Santals- freedom-loving people

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- Bengal , Bihar and Orissa under British rule

()

- people were forced to pay more rents

()

- People's property and lands taken away

()

- British collector Clearland tried to bring

()

- the Santals under control

()

- Cleareland was killed

()

- Government tried to put down the rebellion

()

- Tilka Majhi was arrested and hanged

(b) Write the answers to the following questions:

(i) Where and when was Tilka Majhi born ?

(ii) What did he teach to the young men of the village?

(iii) Who became the ruler of their land after the Plassey Battle?

(iv) What did the king do to collect rent from the tribals ?

(v) How did the landlords trouble the tribals?

(vi) What did Tilka ask people not to do ?

(vii) What did the government do to bring the Santals under control?

(viii) How long did the tribal rebellion continue ?

(ix) How did the great son of soil breathe his last ?

(x) Who was Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan?

(xi) When did he visit Tilka Chhak ? Why ?
